



World Kindness Day

World Kindness Day is 13 November every year. The assembly here goes on the Monday of that week, and then five minutes of form time each morning builds up to the day itself: a compliment, a postcard and a shout-out. The assembly is built on real research, and every finding names its source on the slide.

Before you start. Compliment Chain needs a different classmate's name on every note before Monday, so do that the week before. Read every compliment and every shout-out before it is handed back or pinned up.

Print these

What	What it is
Page 2	The week, day by day, with what to say each morning, and the research behind the assembly. For you.
Compliment Chain	The compliment notes, one per student. A separate pack.
Praise Postcards	The postcards, one per student, cut once. A separate pack.
The Shout-Out Board	The board header, the rules and a sheet or two of slips. A separate pack.

How it works

When	What you do	Slides
The week before	Book the assembly. Print the three packs, write a name on every compliment note, and cut the postcards.	
Monday	Run the assembly. It takes about ten minutes. Then in form time, everyone writes one compliment.	1 to 11
Tuesday to Thursday	Five minutes each morning, as page 2 sets out: compliments handed back, postcards written, the Shout-Out Board put up.	
Friday	World Kindness Day. Pin up the shout-outs and read two or three of them out loud.	

Worth knowing

- In 2026 World Kindness Day is Friday 13 November, so the assembly is on Monday 9 November. Anti-Bullying Week starts on Monday 16 November, and the last slide points to it.
- No assembly slot? The slides work in form time on the Monday instead. Slide 9 is the week, so leave it up while you explain.
- The Shout-Out Board can stay up for the rest of the year, and a stack of Praise Postcards in a drawer keeps being useful long after the week.

More free assemblies and form time activities are on the way. Follow @thepastoralguide to hear when they land.





The week, day by day

Five minutes each morning. Each day says what happens and what you might say.

Day	What happens	What you might say
Monday	Compliment Chain. Hand out the named notes. Everyone writes something true and kind about the person on their note, with no name at the bottom. Collect them all before the bell.	"Write something you have actually noticed about them, not just that they are nice."
Tuesday	Read every note first. Then hand each student the one written about them, and give the room a minute to read.	"You do not have to share yours. Just read it."
Wednesday	Praise Postcards. Each student writes one postcard to a teacher or to another student, and circles which. Deliver them at break, or collect them and pass them on.	"Pick someone who has helped you this term, and say what they did."
Thursday	Put up the Shout-Out Board. Explain the two rules, then everyone writes a slip for a classmate who helped them. Slips go in a tray, not straight on the wall.	"Write what they actually did. You cannot put yourself on it."
Friday	World Kindness Day. Read the slips, pin them all up, and read two or three out loud.	"Remember the hot chocolate? What small thing did someone do for you this week?"

The research behind the assembly

Slide	What it found	Source
4	People giving a stranger a hot chocolate rated the act 3.8 out of 10. The people getting it rated it 7.0.	Kumar and Epley (2023), Journal of Experimental Psychology: General
5	People paying a compliment underestimated how good it would make the other person feel, and overestimated how awkward it would be.	Boothby and Bohns (2021), Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin
6	People writing a thank-you letter underestimated how surprised and happy the person reading it would be.	Kumar and Epley (2018), Psychological Science
7	9 to 11 year olds who did three kind acts a week for four weeks gained about twice as many new peer nominations as a comparison group.	Layous and colleagues (2012), PLoS ONE
8	Across 27 studies, being kind gave the person doing it a small but real lift in wellbeing.	Curry and colleagues (2018), Journal of Experimental Social Psychology

If a note or a slip is unkind, take it out quietly and write a replacement yourself, so nobody goes without one. Everyone writes one, and everyone gets one.

